Clemens Mill School Council
Meeting Minutes
December 10, 2025

ATTENDEES
(V = voting member)

Robert Wilson - Principal
Andi Gourlay - Vice-Principal
Kim Fowler - community rep
Bibi Corbeil - teacher rep
Cherain Serrador - Chair
Vasco Serrador (V)
Chantelle Tinnes (V)
Zac Jones (V)
Rhonda Chamberlain (V)
Shannon Wall (V)
Christine Dalsto (V)
Yvonne Branski (V)
Vina Danger (V)
Cindy Ma (V)
Stephanie MacLachlan (V)
Selena Mather (V)
Dipesh Patel (V)
Rene Corbeil (V)
Rebecca Goodard

Regrets
Ashley Church (V)
Amy Ellison (V)

Meeting Minutes

1. **Welcome**
   - Chair advised that YMCA daycare should be invited to attend the School Council meetings. They will be added to the invite list for the next meeting.

2. **Principals Update**
   - School Sign
     - An electrician from the first contractor has been out and looked at the current sign and the work to be done, but has provided no update.
     - Two other contractors have been approached but have not responded.
   - Parking
     - An official from the Student Transportation Services of Waterloo Region (STSWR) came to the school to view the parking lot at the start of the day and talk about options.
     - Flow map proposed for increased safety.

    - Looking into dates to collect data on walking/biking/rolling to school.
    - Proposal for information sessions for kids at the school e.g. bike safety. The hope being that the kids will share the info with their families.
    - Reviewing and updating the Drive to 5 map, including looking into any changes in street parking signage.
    - Encouraging walking and wheeling.
- Snow Clearing
    - has not been to the required standard.
    - Mr. Wilson has spoken to the Superintendent and the contractors and it seems to be a WRDSB wide issue.
    - The school will try to work with the contractors to ensure sufficient removal.

3. EQAO results

- EQAO results have been released later this year than usual.
- Primary results, Grade 3 Math and Literacy
    - Results last year saw a dip, possibly due to change in format of the testing (physical to digital).
    - This year progress/increase has been seen in all areas showing that the primary focused initiative is making a difference.
- Junior results, Grade 6 Math and Literacy
    - Literacy scores have increased.
    - Struggling in math, however lots of kids were close to meeting the math standard.
- Staff are working on ideas and resources for improving math and literacy including looking at which students are struggling and why.

4. Questions and Answers

- How do the results of current Grade 6 compare to when they were in Grade 3?
    - No data for this. When they were in Grade 3 there was no EQAO due to COVID.
- Does the school have access to individual students' results?
    - Yes. The school is packaging up all the individual results and will then send out/release them to parents.
- How can the school council support the EQAO with money for materials (games or tools) or programs ?
    - The teachers are well resourced, it is more a question of how the resources can best be used. More important is to see which students are struggling and why and what do these students need to get them up to the standard. Also note that EQAO is only one data point that the school collects and uses.
- Does the testing take into account neurodivergence?
    - Not really. All kids are lumped together, however IEPs do refer to how to help kids do better in the EQAO.
- Are there any EQAO prep programs offered at the school to help prepare them for tests?
    - No. The EQAO is meant to show where the students are with regard to the standards and students are not required to pass the EQAO at this level. Teachers

are teaching to the EQAO standard everyday in class. An EQAO prep program could be exclusionary for families who don't have the time or resources.

- Are student behaviours impacting learning?
  - Yes
- Could the school provide parents with a list of games that could help?
  - Yes and some teachers already do e.g. Spark reading, however some only work during school hours. There is the possibility that the school council could fund some games that could be checked out from the library.
- Teachers are under-resourced and need more EA support. Is the board aware of the EQAO results?
  - Yes the board and higher ups are aware of the struggles and are doing their best to resource and support schools with the money they have. The Chair advises that parents are able to request a question for the WRDSB meetings and can email trustees also.
- What specific things is the school doing to address the EQAO results?
  - The school has hired a math coach from the board to help Grades 3 and 6 teachers on how to apply math tools and lessons. This math coaching has seen an increase in previous schools results.
  - A literacy coach will also be starting in the future.
  - Coaches will work with both teachers and the students who need help.
- Regarding the parking lot situation, is there any education focused on the parents as they are the ones driving?
  - No specific education for the parents, instead information will be provided to the children to pass along to the family. Bylaw has been called on the parking lot recently, and at least one ticket and multiple warnings have been given out.

5. Budget Update

- Ended at $50.4k
- Up $1.2k since last month due to prepaid pizza
- No expenses in November

6. Bingo Update

- 10 assignments/shifts released for next year
- Only parents who have expressed interest in bingo are receiving emails so as not to spam anyone. If you are interested please contact V. Serrador.
- K. Fowler advised that there is construction planned out the front of the bingo hall and they are concerned it will decrease customers. So take as many shifts as you can as shift numbers may decrease.

7. Funding Proposals

- All funding proposals sent to the Chair have been shared with Mr. Wilson. Some of the suggestions are hard to fund e.g. gymnastics equipment as that requires coaches who have training/qualifications in that specific equipment.

- Mr. Wilson's priority is to fund programs that would have an impact now/soon, specifically music instruments, games and Scientist in Schools.
- Music Instruments, proposed $5k
    - Music teacher has put in a grant application for $5k for yukeles, digital drums, keyboards and technology based items.
    - Last year the music teacher requested $17k for orchestral instruments and was denied.
    - Music is for Grades 6-8.
    - Chair advised that they did not think $5k was sufficient, but should be closer to $10-15K.
    - Mr. Wilson suggested that instead of a large funding chunk, the council allocates funds on a regular basis to the music program.
    - Suggested that increased funding for musical instruments would allow the school to buy 1 or 2 of a few different instruments.
    - Council members asked if they would support an increase in funding for musical instruments, and council responded in the positive.
    - Motion by S. MacLachlan to vote on $10k for musical instruments
        - 11 YES, motion passed

- Board Games for numeracy/literacy, proposed $2-3K
    - Available at the library for classrooms to use, or students to signout and take home.
    - Motion by Z. Jones to vote on $2k for games
        - 11 YES, motion PASSED

- Scientist in Schools, proposed $2k
    - Presenters come into the school and do a 1.5-2hr session on a science subject to support the curriculum.
    - Offer it to teachers to use as a resource if they want.
    - Also provides a professional development opportunity for the teachers.
    - Approx $200-400 per session.
    - Motion by Z. Jones to vote on $3k for Scientist in Schools
        - 11 YES, motion PASSED

- Volleyball nets, proposed $2-3k
    - Not yet priced out but should be relatively inexpensive.
    - Suggestion to construct a second pit, however this would be too expensive due to the requirement to dig a new pit.
    - HOLD any decision making until Spring. Quotes and Pricing to be provided and discussed in Jan/Feb council meeting.

- Landscaping
    - HOLD any decision making until Spring. Quotes and Pricing to be provided and discussed in Jan/Feb council meeting.

- PALS
    - pinnies are approx 20 years old and no longer used as they are falling apart. Possibility to buy some new pinnies for the PALS when doing outside activities.
    - Popup soccer nets would also be helpful, as they currently share with the gymnasium.
    - K. Fowler notes that Fiddlesticks has some new popup soccer nets that they purchased but have not used. Would be willing to sell them to the school at a 25% discount rate, receipt would be provided.
    - HOLD until Jan meeting to allow time to obtain quotes/pricing information.

- <u>Total spending approved at council meeting $15k</u>

8. Meeting close

- Next meeting IN PERSON Wednesday January 14 @ 7pm.
- Catering provided by UNO Marketplace.
- Virtual attendance will still be provided for.